

BARCELONA TO MADRID

Competitive Advantage in the Leisure Industries: Spain

Six days inside the world's most competitive leisure economy – congress halls and cava cellars, a Formula 1 circuit, two member-owned football clubs, a golden triangle of museums, and the airport that moves more passengers than any operator on earth.

13–18 SEP 2026 FACULTY: MARTINE HAAS · MIREIA LIZANDRA TA: AIMEE LA FRANCE
9 CLASS SESSIONS · 17 SPEAKERS

DAY 1 OF 6 · BARCELONA

SUNDAY 13 — ARRIVAL

Drop the bags, meet the cohort, and hear the argument the whole week is built to test: that leisure is not a soft industry but a fifth of the economy.

FIRST CALL	LAST ITEM	CLASS SESSIONS	SPEAKERS	ITEMS
16:00	21:00	1	2	5

16:00 + Hotel check-in opens

LOCATION — HOTEL CATALONIA BOULEVARD

17:00 ● Coffee available

17:30 ■ **Class Session 1 — Welcome**

Prof. Martine Haas — Vice Dean for Global Initiatives, Wharton

Dr. Mireia Lizandra — Sports management & Olympic movement

LEVEL A, CRILLON-ROBERT ROOM · AT THE HOTEL

The framing session. Travel, hospitality, sport, entertainment, media and gastronomy together account for roughly a fifth of most national economies – and Spain has built more competitive advantage in them than almost anywhere.

18:30 • **Cocktail dinner — Rooftop Event Bar**

PARTNERS WELCOME

Your first view over the Eixample roofline. Look north-east along Carrer del Rosselló and the Sagrada Família towers should be showing above the blocks.

21:00 — **End of dinner**

MONDAY 14 — THE CITY AS A PRODUCT

A full day on Montjuïc and beyond: how a city sells itself to congresses, how a Grand Prix becomes an economic instrument, and how tapas became an export.

FIRST CALL	LAST ITEM	CLASS SESSIONS	SPEAKERS	ITEMS
07:00	23:30	5	4	21

07:00 • Breakfast in the restaurant

INCLUDED

07:45 › Meet in the lobby — sharp — for the bus to MNAC

7:45 AM MEANS 7:45 AM

08:30 • Welcome coffee at MNAC

LOCATION — MNAC — MUSEU NACIONAL D'ART DE CATALUNYA

09:00 ■ Class Session 2 — Barcelona's economic promotion machine

Mario Rubert — Director of International Economic Promotion, Barcelona Activa (Barcelona City Council)

Barcelona Activa is the City Council's economic development arm, born in 1986 out of the collapse of industrial Poblenou — the neighbourhood later rebranded 22@ and turned into an innovation district. Few cities have run the playbook this deliberately.

LOCATION — MNAC — MUSEU NACIONAL D'ART DE CATALUNYA

10:15 • Coffee break

10:30 ■ Class Session 2 (cont.) — Business Tourism: Travel versus MICE

Maite Audet — Lecturer, University of Barcelona

MICE — Meetings, Incentives, Conferences, Exhibitions — is the high-margin half of tourism: it fills hotels midweek, out of season, with delegates who spend multiples of a leisure visitor. Barcelona now ranks third in the world for hosting congresses.

11:45 -- End of presentations

12:00 ◇ **Private tour of the MNAC**

LOCATION — MNAC — MUSEU NACIONAL D'ART DE CATALUNYA

12:45 -- Group photo

13:00 ● **Lunch in the museum**

14:30 › **Walk uphill to INEF (15 min) — or take the bus**

THIS IS THE SENSIBLE-SHOES MOMENT

LOCATION — INEF — INSTITUT NACIONAL D'EDUCACIÓ FÍSICA DE CATALUNYA

15:00 ■ **Class Session 3 — Sporting events as drivers of the MICE industry: Formula 1 and MotoGP**

Isabel Juárez — Commercial Director, Circuit de Barcelona-Catalunya (part of Fira Barcelona)

A race weekend is really a three-day trade fair with engines: hospitality suites, sponsor activations, and hotel nights bought a year in advance. Hence a racetrack sitting inside a trade-fair group.

LOCATION — CIRCUIT DE BARCELONA-CATALUNYA

16:15 ■ **Class Session 3 (cont.) — Sports presentation**

SPEAKER ANNOUNCED AT THE SESSION

17:30 › **Bus to Spotify Camp Nou**

LOCATION — SPOTIFY CAMP NOU

18:00 ◇ **Visit the museum store**

LOCATION — SPOTIFY CAMP NOU

19:00 › **Bus departs for the hotel**

19:30 › **Arrive at the hotel**

19:45 › **Walk to Bar Vint-i-Quatre**

LOCATION — BAR VINT-I-QUATRE

20:30 ■ **Presentation by Chef Carles Abellan**

Carles Abellan – Top tapas chef; formerly of elBulli under Ferran Adrià

NO PARTNERS

Spanish gastronomy is a case study in deliberate brand-building: a national cuisine turned into a destination driver through technique, Michelin stars and relentless regional marketing.

21:00 ● **Interactive tapas dinner with Chef Abellan**

Open kitchen – he cooks and plates in front of you, narrating the technique as he goes.

LOCATION – BAR VINT-I-QUATRE

23:30 – **Return to the hotel**

TUESDAY 15 — FROM THE PORT TO THE VINEYARD

Cruise economics in the morning, cava cellars in the afternoon, and a 300 km/h line to Madrid after dark. Bags travel with you – the hotel changes tonight.

FIRST CALL	LAST ITEM	CLASS SESSIONS	SPEAKERS	ITEMS
07:00	23:30	2	2	15

07:00 ● Breakfast in the restaurant

INCLUDED · PACK BEFORE YOU COME DOWN

09:00 ■ Class Session 4 — The cruise business

Mateo Asensio — Former Cruise Area Director, Barcelona Consortium

LEVEL A, CRILLON-ROBERT ROOM · AT THE HOTEL

Barcelona is Europe's busiest cruise port and its most contested one. The city has been cutting terminals in the old port and pushing ships away from the centre – the sharp end of the overtourism argument in your readings.

10:30 ● Coffee break

11:00 > Two minibuses depart for Gramona — with luggage

CHECK OUT FIRST

LOCATION — GRAMONA — SANT SADURNÍ D'ANOIA

12:00 ● Arrival at Gramona — snack and a glass of rosé

LOCATION — GRAMONA — SANT SADURNÍ D'ANOIA

12:30 ◇ Visit the cellar

Underground galleries where bottles rest on their lees for years. The top wines here age far longer than most Champagne.

LOCATION — GRAMONA — SANT SADURNÍ D'ANOIA

13:30 ■ **Class Session 5 — Wine tourism as a business**

Miquel Herrero — Head of Hospitality and Wine Tourism, Gramona

Enotourism turns an agricultural producer into a hospitality brand: the same bottle, sold at the cellar door with a story attached, carries a completely different margin.

LOCATION — GRAMONA — SANT SADURNÍ D'ANOIA

14:30 ● **Lunch at the winery**

16:30 ◆ **Visit the Gramona vineyards**

SENSIBLE SHOES AGAIN

17:45 › **Bus departs for Barcelona Sants station**

LOCATION — BARCELONA SANTS + THE IRYO TO MADRID

18:30 › **Partners only — transfer from hotel to station**

19:40 › **Iryo high-speed train, Barcelona → Madrid**

TICKETS SECURED FOR PARTNERS TOO

Roughly three hours and 620 kilometres. Sit on the right leaving Barcelona for the last of the light over the Penedès you just drove through.

LOCATION — BARCELONA SANTS + THE IRYO TO MADRID

22:42 › **Arrive in Madrid**

23:00 › **Bus with bags to the hotel**

LOCATION — VP PLAZA ESPAÑA DESIGN

23:30 — **Hotel check-in**

ROOMS WILL BE READY — CARD FOR INCIDENTALS ONLY

LOCATION — VP PLAZA ESPAÑA DESIGN

WEDNESDAY 16 — THE EXPERIENCE ECONOMY

Madrid's convention machine, a nightclub leveraged buyout, a unicorn that sells candlelit concerts, and a stadium rebuilt to work 365 days a year. Then the evening is yours.

FIRST CALL	LAST ITEM	CLASS SESSIONS	SPEAKERS	ITEMS
07:00	18:30	3	5	12

07:00 • Breakfast in the restaurant

INCLUDED

08:15 > Meet in the lobby — metro or walk to the Thyssen

PASEO DEL PRADO 8

On foot it is a pleasant half-hour down the Gran Vía and along the Paseo del Prado — a UNESCO World Heritage boulevard since 2021.

LOCATION — MUSEO NACIONAL THYSSEN-BORNEMISZA

09:15 ■ Class Session 6 — Madrid as a convention destination

Ignacio Gutiérrez de Yturriaga — General Manager, Madrid Convention Bureau

MIRADOR ROOM

The direct counterweight to Monday's Barcelona session: two Spanish cities competing for the same congresses, with different assets and different arguments.

LOCATION — MUSEO NACIONAL THYSSEN-BORNEMISZA

10:45 • Coffee break

11:00 ■ Class Session 6 (cont.) — The Pacha deal

Javier Garcia-Polencia — CEO, Investment Banking

Javier Olascoaga — Senda Investment Partners

Pacha began in Sitges in 1967 and opened in Ibiza in 1973; the twin cherries became one of the few genuinely global nightlife brands. Its sale to private equity is a rare, clean case of financial buyers underwriting a party.

- 12:30 ◇ **Private tour of a collection at the Thyssen**
LOCATION – MUSEO NACIONAL THYSSEN-BORNEMISZA
-
- 13:30 ● **Lunch at the museum**
-
- 15:00 ■ **Class Session 7 — Manufacturing demand for live experience**
Rocío Trujillo Alba – Regional General Manager, South Europe – Fever
Jorge Laso Magro – Institutional Relations Specialist – Fever
- Fever was founded in Madrid in 2014 and became a unicorn by inventing the events it sells: Candlelight concerts now run in well over a hundred cities. Discovery platform on one side, production studio on the other.
-
- 16:15 ● **Coffee break**
-
- 16:30 › **Bus departs for the Santiago Bernabéu**
LOCATION – ESTADIO SANTIAGO BERNABÉU
-
- 17:00 ◇ **Stadium tour with local guides**
LOCATION – ESTADIO SANTIAGO BERNABÉU
-
- 18:30 ○ **End of visit — free evening**
NO TRANSPORT BOOKED FROM THE STADIUM

YOUR ONE FREE EVENING

WHERE TO GO FROM THE BERNABÉU

You are in Chamartín with no bus home, which is a gift. Line 10 from Santiago Bernabéu runs straight into the centre in about fifteen minutes.

Plaza Mayor & Mercado de San Miguel The postcard square, and a wrought-iron market hall from 1916 now packed with counters. Touristy, delicious, and five minutes from Sol. [MAP](#)

Sobrino de Botín Opened 1725 and recognised as the oldest continuously operating restaurant in the world. Roast suckling pig in a wood oven that has never gone cold. Book ahead. [MAP](#)

Azotea del Círculo de Bellas Artes The rooftop with the best view in Madrid – Gran Vía on one side, the Prado's treeline on the other. Small entry fee, worth every cent at sunset. [MAP](#)

Salamanca, for dinner near the stadium If you would rather not travel: the grid east of the Bernabéu is Madrid's most expensive neighbourhood and its densest concentration of good restaurants. [MAP](#)

THURSDAY 17 — AIRPORTS, ATHLETES, PLATFORMS

The final teaching day runs from airport economics to a footballer-turned-founder to the regulatory street fight over ride-hailing – and closes with wine.

FIRST CALL	LAST ITEM	CLASS SESSIONS	SPEAKERS	ITEMS
07:00	20:30	6	7	14

07:00 • Breakfast in the restaurant

INCLUDED

09:00 ■ Class Session 8 — Airport economics: the case of Aena

Julio García Cobos – Founding Partner, PQAXIS; Adjunct Professor, IE Business School

ROOMS 026 / 027 / 028 / 029 • AT THE HOTEL

Aena runs 46 Spanish airports and handles more passengers than any other operator on earth. Its 2015 partial privatisation was the largest IPO in Spanish history, and the state still holds the majority – a live experiment in regulated infrastructure with public shareholders.

10:15 • Coffee break

10:30 ■ Class Session 8 (cont.) — Beyond the Pitch: an entrepreneur's playbook for modern football

Esteban Granero – Co-founder, BEST 11 GROUP

Granero came through Real Madrid's academy and played in the first team, at QPR and Real Sociedad. He is better known now as one of the game's most cerebral figures – he also co-founded an AI company applying predictive models to recruitment.

12:00 ■ Class Session 8 (cont.) — Presentation by Kaizen Play

Ignacio Aguillo – Founder and CEO, Kaizen Play

13:15	➤	Walk to Café de Oriente
		LOCATION – CAFÉ DE ORIENTE
13:30	●	Lunch at Café de Oriente
		The Royal Palace is directly across the square. If there is any gap after lunch, walk the twenty metres to the railing and look.
		LOCATION – CAFÉ DE ORIENTE
15:00	■	Class Session 9 — Platforms and regulation
		Felipe Fernández Aramburu – General Manager, Uber Spain
		Uber launched in Barcelona in 2014 and was shut down by the courts within months. It returned to Madrid as a licensed operator, pulled out of Barcelona again in 2019 over a pre-booking rule, then came back working with taxi drivers. Spain's taxi-versus-VTC fight is the sharpest in Europe.
16:15	●	Coffee break
16:30	■	Class Session 9 (cont.) — Wrap-up
		Prof. Martine Haas
		Dr. Mireia Lizandra
17:45	--	Finish wrap-up
18:30	■	Wine-tasting presentation
		Eduardo Ferrín – CEO, Alto Winery
		Spain has more land under vine than any country on earth – and still sits behind Italy and France on volume, because so much of it is old, low-yield bush vine. That gap is the whole opportunity in Spanish wine.
19:00	●	Wine tasting with tapas dinner
		PARTNERS WELCOME
20:30	--	End of the programme — farewell

FRIDAY 18 — HASTA LUEGO

Breakfast, then departures. If your flight is late enough, Madrid is eminently walkable before you go.

FIRST CALL	LAST ITEM	CLASS SESSIONS	SPEAKERS	ITEMS
07:00	07:00	—	—	2

07:00 ● Breakfast in the restaurant

INCLUDED

— ○ Travel safely

Barajas is about 30–40 minutes from Plaza de España by taxi, or line 8 of the metro from Nuevos Ministerios.

IF YOU HAVE A FEW HOURS

FOUR THINGS WITHIN WALKING DISTANCE

All four are a short walk or one metro stop from the hotel. Bags can usually be left at reception after checkout.

Museo del Prado Velázquez's *Las Meninas*, Goya's black paintings, Bosch's *Garden of Earthly Delights*. Two hours is enough for the greatest hits; free entry in the last two hours of the day. [MAP](#)

Parque del Retiro The former royal pleasure garden, public since 1868. Row a boat, or find the *Palacio de Cristal* – an 1887 glasshouse built to show off Philippine plants. [MAP](#)

Palacio Real & Sabatini Gardens Ten minutes downhill from the hotel. The largest functioning royal palace in Western Europe, built after the old *Alcázar* burned down on Christmas Eve 1734. [MAP](#)

Templo de Debod An actual 2nd-century BC Egyptian temple, given to Spain in 1968 and rebuilt stone by stone behind your hotel. Best at sunset, and it is free. [MAP](#)

PLACES & STORIES

01 HOTEL CATALONIA BOULEVARD

BARCELONA

SUNDAY 13

EIXAMPLE DISTRICT · CERDÀ GRID, 1860

A SHORT HISTORY

You are sleeping inside a piece of urban-planning history. When Barcelona tore down its medieval walls, engineer Ildefons Cerdà drew the Eixample – a grid of near-identical blocks with chamfered corners so light, air and traffic could all turn freely. He justified it with his own mortality survey of the cramped old city, making it one of the first city plans argued from data rather than taste.

FUN FACT

Walk one block and you are at Gaudí's La Pedrera; walk ten minutes down Passeig de Gràcia and you hit the Illa de la Discòrdia, where Gaudí, Puig i Cadafalch and Domènech i Montaner each built a house side by side and let the neighbours judge.

Carrer del Rosselló 249, Eixample, 08008
Barcelona

02 MNAC — MUSEU NACIONAL D'ART DE CATALUNYA

BARCELONA

MONDAY 14

PALAU NACIONAL, BUILT 1929

A SHORT HISTORY

The Palau Nacional was thrown up as the centrepiece of the 1929 Barcelona International Exposition and never came down. Its greatest holding came from a rescue mission: in the 1920s, alarmed that Romanesque frescoes were being stripped from remote Pyrenean churches and sold abroad, Catalan scholars hired Italian technicians to peel the paintings off the apse walls onto canvas and bring them down the mountains. The result is the finest collection of Romanesque mural painting anywhere.

FUN FACT

That same 1929 Expo produced Mies van der Rohe's German Pavilion a few hundred metres downhill – and with it the Barcelona Chair, still in production almost a century later. One world's fair, two permanent exports.

Palau Nacional, Parc de Montjuïc, 08038
Barcelona

INEF — INSTITUT NACIONAL D'EDUCACIÓ FÍSICA DE CATALUNYA

BARCELONA

MONDAY 14

RICARDO BOFILL, 1991 · OLYMPIC RING

A SHORT HISTORY

Ricardo Bofill's colonnaded courtyards were finished in 1991 as part of the Anella Olímpica – the Olympic Ring assembled on Montjuïc for Barcelona '92, alongside the rebuilt Estadi Olímpic and Arata Isozaki's Palau Sant Jordi. It is a sports school that looks like a Roman forum, which is very much the point.

FUN FACT

Barcelona '92 is the founding case study in event-led urban regeneration: the city used the Games to turn itself around to face the sea, replacing rail yards and factories with the Port Olímpic and four kilometres of new beach. The opening ceremony's flaming arrow got the headlines; the beach was the real legacy.

Av. de l'Estadi 12-22, Anella Olímpica, Montjuïc

CIRCUIT DE BARCELONA-CATALUNYA

BARCELONA

MONDAY 14

OPENED 1991

A SHORT HISTORY

Built in Montmeló in the run-up to the 1992 Games, the circuit has hosted the Formula 1 Spanish Grand Prix and the MotoGP Gran Premi de Catalunya ever since. Two race weekends a year turn a suburban industrial town into an international media venue.

FUN FACT

Because its lap mixes long straights, high-speed sweepers and slow corners, F1 teams historically treated it as the sport's benchmark test track – if a car works here, it works everywhere. Engineers know its corner numbers better than most drivers know their own street.

Montmeló, ~30 km north of Barcelona

05 SPOTIFY CAMP NOU

BARCELONA

MONDAY 14

OPENED 1957 · REBUILT 2023–

A SHORT HISTORY

FC Barcelona outgrew its old ground at Les Corts and opened this one in 1957. For decades the club called it simply the Estadi; members voted to make the nickname Camp Nou – 'new field' – the official name in 2001. It has been Europe's largest stadium for most of its life and is currently mid-rebuild under the Espai Barça project.

FUN FACT

Barça has no owner to sell it. It belongs to its socis, who elect the president – which is what 'més que un club,' more than a club, was originally getting at. When Spotify bought the naming rights in 2022, it was the first time in the club's history that the stadium carried a sponsor's name at all.

C. d'Arístides Maillol 12, Les Corts, 08028
Barcelona

06 BAR VINT-I-QUATRE

BARCELONA

MONDAY 14

CARLES ABELLAN · ELBULLI LINEAGE

A SHORT HISTORY

Vint-i-quatre is Catalan for twenty-four – a nod to Tapas 24, the counter that made Carles Abellan's name. Abellan cooked under Ferran Adrià at elBulli before going out on his own with the idea that avant-garde technique should be pointed at the humblest food on the menu: the sandwich, the croquette, the tinned seafood.

FUN FACT

elBulli closed in 2011 at the absolute peak of its fame, holding three Michelin stars and reportedly fielding around two million reservation requests a year for roughly eight thousand seats. Abellan's most famous dish is a descendant of that era: a pressed ham-and-cheese 'bikini' upgraded with Ibérico and truffle.

Barcelona – walking distance from the hotel

07 GRAMONA — SANT SADURNÍ D'ANOIA

PENEDÈS

TUESDAY 15

FOUNDED 1881 · FIVE GENERATIONS

A SHORT HISTORY

Sant Sadurní d'Anoia is the town that makes the overwhelming majority of Spain's cava, and Gramona has been part of it since 1881. The whole industry traces to the 1870s, when a Sant Sadurní grower returned from Champagne and made the first Spanish sparkling wine by the traditional bottle-fermented method – then phylloxera killed the region's red vines and pushed Penedès decisively toward white grapes.

FUN FACT

In 2019 Gramona and a handful of other top estates walked out of the Cava appellation entirely to found Corpinnat, a mark that demands organic estate-grown fruit, hand harvesting and long ageing. It is a textbook live case: what premium producers do when a mass-market appellation stops signalling quality.

Sant Sadurní d'Anoia, Alt Penedès, Catalonia

08 BARCELONA SANTS + THE IRYO TO MADRID

PENEDÈS

TUESDAY 15

SPAIN'S HIGH-SPEED SPINE

A SHORT HISTORY

The Madrid–Barcelona high-speed line opened in 2008 and rewired one of the busiest air corridors in the world; rail took the majority of the market within a few years. In 2021 Spain became the first country in Europe to throw its domestic high-speed network fully open to competition. Iryo – backed by Trenitalia and running Frecciarossa 1000 trainsets – launched into that opening in 2022.

FUN FACT

Spain has the longest high-speed rail network in Europe and the second longest on earth, behind only China. When three operators started fighting over the same Madrid–Barcelona tracks, fares fell sharply and ridership jumped – deregulation you can measure from your seat.

Plaça dels Països Catalans, 08014 Barcelona

09 VP PLAZA ESPAÑA DESIGN

MADRID

TUESDAY 15

PLAZA REBUILT 2021

A SHORT HISTORY

Plaza de España sits at the head of the Gran Vía, hemmed in by the Edificio España (1953) and the Torre de Madrid (1957) – both briefly among the tallest buildings in the world, and both monuments to Franco-era ambition in reinforced concrete. The square itself was torn up and rebuilt as a pedestrian park in 2021, burying the traffic and stitching it to the Sabatini Gardens.

FUN FACT

At its centre stands the 1929 monument to Cervantes, with Don Quixote and Sancho Panza cast in bronze below him. And Madrid sits at roughly 650 metres – the highest capital city in the European Union, which is why the light is so hard and the nights get cold so fast.

Plaza de España 5, Centro, 28008 Madrid

10 MUSEO NACIONAL THYSSEN-BORNEMISZA

MADRID

WEDNESDAY 16

PALACIO DE VILLAHERMOSA • ACQUIRED 1993

A SHORT HISTORY

Two generations of the Thyssen-Bornemisza family assembled what became the largest private art collection in the world after the British Royal Collection. When the baron went looking for a permanent home in the late 1980s, Britain, Switzerland, Japan and the Getty all competed for it – and Spain won, helped considerably by his Spanish wife. The state leased it, then bought it outright in 1993 for a sum widely regarded since as a steal.

FUN FACT

It completes Madrid's Golden Triangle of Art with the Prado and the Reina Sofía, and it was designed to fill their gaps: Italian primitives, Dutch masters, German Expressionism, American Pop. UNESCO listed the whole Paseo del Prado and Retiro ensemble as a World Heritage Site in 2021.

Paseo del Prado 8, 28014 Madrid

11 ESTADIO SANTIAGO BERNABÉU

MADRID

WEDNESDAY 16

OPENED 1947 · REBORN 2023-25

A SHORT HISTORY

Opened in 1947 as the Nuevo Estadio Chamartín and renamed in 1955 for Santiago Bernabéu – who played for Real Madrid, then coached it, then ran it as president for 35 years, and who pushed hard for the creation of the European Cup. Like Barça, Real Madrid is owned by its members rather than an investor.

FUN FACT

The billion-euro-plus renovation was designed to solve a business problem, not a football one: a stadium used forty days a year is dead capital. So the pitch now slides into an underground chamber with its own lighting and ventilation, clearing the bowl for concerts and events – a football ground rebuilt as a 365-day venue.

Av. de Concha Espina 1, Chamartín, 28036 Madrid

12 CAFÉ DE ORIENTE

MADRID

THURSDAY 17

ON A 17TH-CENTURY CONVENT

A SHORT HISTORY

The café faces the Royal Palace across Plaza de Oriente and stands on the site of the old Convento de San Gil; its cellars are the convent's. It opened in 1983 under Padre Lezama, a priest who ran restaurants to fund work with ex-offenders – which is why one of Madrid's most photogenic terraces began life as a social enterprise.

FUN FACT

The square in front of you exists because Joseph Bonaparte demolished an entire medieval quarter to make it. Madrileños repaid him with the nickname 'el Rey Plazuelas' – the King of Little Squares. Behind it, the Royal Palace is the largest functioning royal palace in Western Europe, with well over three thousand rooms.

Plaza de Oriente 2, 28013 Madrid

BARCELONA – NIGHTS 1-2

Hotel Catalonia Boulevard
Carrer del Rosselló 249, Eixample
[+34 934 15 99 11](tel:+34934159911)
Formerly the Gallery Hotel

DRESS CODE

No flip-flops, shorts, or t-shirts. Otherwise, anything goes. Bring sensible shoes for walking and vineyards. **No jackets, suits, or ties needed.**

DEADLINES

Group reflection paper – **22 Sep, 5:00 pm EST**
Final individual paper – **12 Oct, 5:00 pm EST**

MADRID – NIGHTS 3-5

VP Plaza España Design
Plaza de España 5, Centro
[+34 915 95 55 10](tel:+34915955510)
Rooms ready on late arrival – card for incidentals only

COURSE SITE

[Canvas – course 1937089](#)
Readings live under Course Materials @ Penn Libraries

ATTENDANCE

All sessions, meals, and activities are mandatory. Arrive on time, stay for the whole session, and no phones during guest speakers.

This schedule is preliminary and subject to change. The syllabus is updated daily – always check Canvas for the current version before you plan your morning. Historical notes and fun facts here are background colour added for the trip, not part of the course materials.